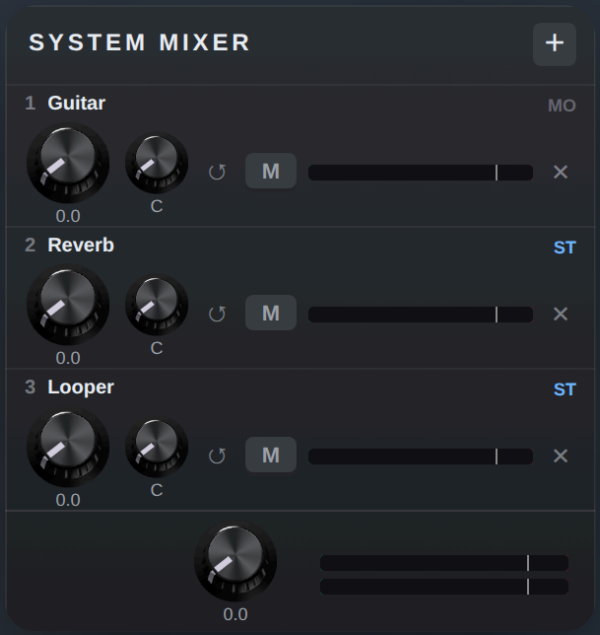
STEFAN

SYSTEM MIXER

Every plugin to one stereo out — no cable spaghetti.



16-channel stereo mixer for MOD Dwarf and MOD Desktop

USER MANUAL · NOVEMBER 2026 EDITION

WHAT THE SYSTEM MIXER DOES

The System Mixer is the **one mixer at the end of your pedalboard**. Instead of dragging two cables from every plugin to the outputs, you right-click a plugin and choose **Send to mixer**. It gets its own channel with a level knob, a pan knob, a mute button and a level meter, and the mixer sends everything to the outputs.

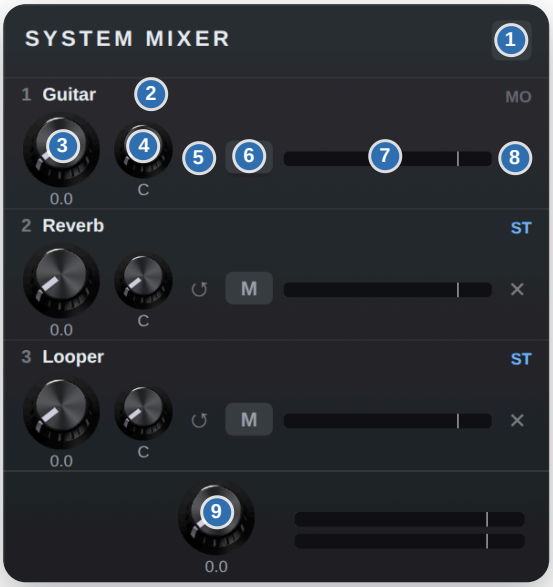
The pedal only shows the channels you are using, so with three plugins sent it is three slim rows tall. It takes up to 16 plugins, mono or stereo, and costs very little processing power — less than a single stock MOD mixer.

> **Good to know:** the mixer is completely clean. It only sets levels and positions in the stereo picture; your tone is untouched.

QUICK START

1. **Add the System Mixer** to your pedalboard (brand **Stefan**). It starts small: a header, a hint and the master knob.
2. **Right-click a plugin** that makes sound and choose **Send to mixer**. The plugin appears as a new row on the mixer, and the mixer connects itself to the outputs the first time.
3. **Repeat** for every plugin you want to hear, or press **+** on the mixer and pick from the list.
4. **Play**, and balance the rows with their GAIN and PAN knobs.

THE PEDAL



1 + (send)

Lists every plugin on the board that has audio outputs and is not in the mixer yet. Pick one to send it.

2 Channel name

The plugin feeding this row, with **ST** (stereo: both outputs connected) or **MO** (mono) next to it.

3 GAIN

How loud this plugin is in the mix. The number under the knob is in dB.

- **Fully left:** silent (shown as −inf)
- **0.0 (default):** exactly as loud as the plugin plays
- **Fully right (+12):** a clear boost for a quiet plugin

4 PAN

Where the plugin sits between the left and right speaker.

- **C (default):** in the middle
- **L100 / R100:** all the way to one side
- **Stereo plugins:** PAN turns down the opposite side, keeping the plugin's own stereo picture

5 ↺ Reset

Puts GAIN back to 0 and PAN back to the centre for this row.

6 M (mute)

Silences the row; it lights red while muted. The meter keeps showing the plugin's level, so you can see it is still playing.

7 Meter

How hot the plugin arrives, before GAIN. The white tick is 0 dB; red beyond it means the plugin itself is too loud.

8 ✕ Remove

Takes this plugin out of the mixer. Its cables to the mixer are unplugged and nothing else is connected, so it goes quiet.

9 MASTER

The level of the whole mix, with the left and right output meters beside it. 0.0 leaves the mix as it is.

SENDING AND REMOVING

Send to mixer

Right-click the body of any plugin with audio outputs and choose **Send to mixer**, or use **+** on the mixer. The plugin takes the first free channel. A stereo plugin uses both sides of it; a mono plugin plays in the middle and its PAN moves it left or right. If the plugin was cabled straight to the outputs, those cables are removed, so you never hear it twice. Cables to other plugins stay as they are.

On the starless firmware the new cables become **teleports**: a short stub with a label at the plugin and at the mixer, instead of a cable across the board. You can rename the label, or turn it back into a normal cable, like any teleport.

Remove from mixer

Right-click the plugin again and choose **Remove from mixer**, or press ✕ on its row. The plugin is unplugged from the mixer and its row disappears.

TIPS

Mute a plugin with a footswitch
Open the mixer’s settings with the cogwheel above the pedal and click the assign icon next to that channel’s **Mute**. Channels are numbered as on the pedal (the number before each name). GAIN and PAN can go on knobs the same way.

Snapshots remember the mix
Gains, pans and mutes are ordinary plugin settings, so a snapshot can switch a whole mix at once — say, the looper louder for the solo.

Leave headroom
Several plugins at 0.0 add up. If the master meters touch red, lower MASTER or the loudest rows rather than boosting the quiet ones.

INSTALLING THE SYSTEM MIXER

Download the build for your platform from the plugin's **GitHub Releases** page: `sysmixer-vX.Y.Z-dwarf-aarch64.tar.gz` for the MOD Dwarf and `sysmixer-vX.Y.Z-linux-amd64.tar.gz` for MOD Desktop.

MOD Desktop (Linux)

1. Extract the archive: `tar xzf sysmixer-vX.Y.Z-linux-amd64.tar.gz`
2. Move the extracted `sysmixer.lv2` folder into `~/Documents/MOD Desktop/lv2/`
3. Restart MOD Desktop. The System Mixer appears under the brand **Stefan**.

MOD Dwarf

1. Connect the Dwarf over USB and extract the Dwarf archive on your computer.
2. Copy the bundle onto the unit:

   ```
   scp -O -r sysmixer.lv2 root@192.168.51.1:/root/.lv2/
   ```

3. Restart the audio services (or simply reboot the Dwarf):

   ```
   ssh root@192.168.51.1 'systemctl restart jack2 mod-ui'
   ```

4. Hard-refresh the MOD web interface in your browser (**Ctrl-Shift-R**).

QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

I don’t see “Send to mixer” when I right-click.

The menu comes from the mixer, so a System Mixer has to be on the pedalboard. Right-click the plugin’s body rather than a jack with cables (that opens the cable menu), and note that plugins without audio outputs, such as MIDI tools, have nothing to send.

A plugin went quiet after I removed it.

That is on purpose: removing only unplugs it from the mixer. Send it again, or cable it wherever you want it.

Does it work without the starless firmware?

Yes. The mixer, the menu and the rows work on any MOD; only the automatic teleports need starless, so elsewhere sends are ordinary cables.

A plugin has more than two outputs.

Send to mixer takes its first two. Cable any others by hand.

Can I use two System Mixers?

You can, but only the first one on the board answers the right-click menu. Send to the second with its **+** button.

SPECIFICATIONS

FORMAT	LV2 audio plugin, 16 stereo inputs → stereo out
PLATFORMS	MOD Dwarf (aarch64), MOD Desktop (Linux x86_64)
PER CHANNEL	Gain −60…+12 dB (bottom = off), pan, mute, meter
MASTER	Gain −60…+12 dB, left/right meters
PAN	Mono: constant power (−3 dB at centre). Stereo: balance.
PROCESSING COST	About 31 µs per 128-sample block on a MOD Dwarf (about 1.2 % of the audio period), whether 1 or 16 channels are in use
LATENCY	None

The System Mixer is free software built with the DISTRHO Plugin Framework. Manual edition November 2026 — for the plugin version it shipped with; see the GitHub release page for the latest.